

ResolvX

Data Destruction Policy

Topic-Specific Policy - Secure Destruction Execution & Verification

POL-020 · v1.0 · 2026 · Internal : Restricted

Document Information

Policy ID	POL-020
Version	1.0
Status	Active
Classification	Internal - Restricted
Owner	GRC Lead
Approver	CISO
Review Cycle	Annual
Next Review	Q3 2027
Frameworks	ISO 27001:2022 A8.10, A7.14 · NIST 800-88 · NIST CSF 2.0 PR.DS-01 · SOC 2 CC6.5

1. Purpose

This Data Destruction Policy establishes how ResolvX actually carries out the secure disposal already required by the Data Classification Policy. The specific method for each media type, how destruction is verified, and how a legal hold overrides a routine destruction schedule when necessary.

Secure destruction is what makes a retention schedule meaningful a documented deadline for deletion means little if the underlying method doesn't reliably render the data unrecoverable. This policy defines that method for each type of system ResolvX data lives in.

2. Relationship to POL-004

- POL-004 (Data Classification Policy) defines what the retention period is for each data category, and names the required disposal standard per classification tier.
- This policy (POL-020) defines how that standard is technically executed for each type of system, how destruction is verified, and how a legal hold interacts with an otherwise-due deletion.

3. Destruction Methods by System Type

System Type	Destruction Method	Executed By
Cloud object storage (S3)	Object deletion with versioning purge. A deleted object's prior versions are also removed, not left recoverable via version history.	Head of Cloud Ops
Database records (RDS)	Row-level deletion for individual records; full instance deletion follows AWS's NIST 800-88-aligned storage sanitisation on decommission.	Head of Cloud Ops
Backups and snapshots	Per §4, backups age out of retention naturally rather than being selectively edited.	Head of Cloud Ops
SaaS platform data (Workspace, Slack, Notion, etc.)	Deletion through the platform's native admin deletion function; where a platform retains a recovery window, destruction is confirmed only once that window has passed.	IT Admin
Physical documents	Cross-cut shredding, consistent with POL-004 §5.2.	All personnel (Restricted/Confidential); IT Admin for bulk disposal
Endpoint devices (laptops)	Jamf-managed remote wipe before reallocation or disposal; physical destruction of the storage medium for devices being retired, not reallocated.	IT Admin

4. Backup-Specific Data Destruction

Selectively deleting one individual's data out of a point-in-time backup snapshot is not technically practical without corrupting the backup's integrity as a recovery artifact, so ResolvX does not attempt to. Instead:

- A deletion request (whether routine retention expiry or a GDPR/CCPA erasure request) is executed immediately against production and any active replica.
- The data may persist in existing backup snapshots until those snapshots themselves age out of the retention schedule already defined in POL-009.
- This gap between production deletion and backup expiry is disclosed as standard practice in the Privacy Programme's data subject communication where relevant, rather than left unexplained if a data subject asks why a backup copy could theoretically still exist.
- Backups are never restored for the specific purpose of manually excising one individual's data as doing so would risk more data integrity harm than the backup's eventual natural expiry.

5. Legal Hold

Data otherwise due for destruction under POL-004's retention schedule is preserved instead when it is subject to litigation, regulatory investigation, or a similar legal obligation to retain.

- Legal places a hold by notifying GRC Lead of the specific data category, date range, and reason; GRC Lead flags the affected register entries and communicates the hold to the relevant system owners from POL-011.
- Data under legal hold is exempt from the destruction methods in §3 and §4 regardless of what the retention schedule would otherwise require, until Legal releases the hold.
- A legal hold is reviewed by Legal at least annually to confirm it remains necessary, rather than persisting indefinitely by default.

6. Verification of Destruction

Destruction of Restricted-tier data is confirmed, not assumed. The executing role (per §3) logs the destruction — what was destroyed, when, and by what method — as evidence retained by GRC Lead. For physical media destruction handled by a third-party vendor, a certificate of destruction is required and retained as audit evidence.

7. Vendor & Sub-Processor Destruction

Where a vendor holding ResolvX data under a Data Processing Agreement (per POL-005) is offboarded, or the contractual basis for their retention of ResolvX data ends, GRC Lead confirms the vendor has deleted or returned ResolvX data per the DPA's own terms as part of vendor offboarding. This policy does not govern the vendor's internal destruction method, only ResolvX's confirmation that it occurred.

8. Roles & Responsibilities

8.1 GRC Lead

- Owns this policy and maintains destruction verification evidence (§6).
- Administers legal holds (§5) and confirms vendor destruction (§7).

8.2 Head of Cloud Ops

- Executes destruction for cloud infrastructure, database, and backup-related systems (§3, §4).

8.3 IT Admin

- Executes destruction for SaaS platforms, physical documents, and endpoint devices (§3).

8.4 Legal

- Places and releases legal holds (§5).

9. Compliance and Enforcement

Destroying data under legal hold or failing to execute required destruction without a documented legal hold justification, is treated as a control deficiency and logged in the Corrective Action Plan.

10. Document Control

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Framework References	ISO/IEC 27001:2022 A8.10, A7.14 · NIST 800-88 · NIST CSF 2.0 PR.DS-01 · SOC 2 TSC CC6.5
Related Documents	POL-004 (Data Classification Policy), POL-005 (Vendor Management Policy), POL-006 (Privacy Programme), POL-009 (Backup & Recovery Policy), POL-011 (Asset Management Policy)

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Authorisation

Role	Name	Date
CEO		
CISO		
GRC Lead		